Brown chicken eggs exhibit a brown colour on the surface only; below they are white

A bit of a different stand with interchangeable goose egg ornaments; internally, there is a fake diamond stickpin

Other examples

I wanted to provide some other examples to illustrate the versatility of including shell as part of your turning project. These are intended to either tease you into trying to use shell and also to give you some ideas to expand your thoughts in to. Don't be bound just by the mechanics of having a shell be a component in your final turning. Use it as a canvas to add colour, shape and texture. The artistic potentials far outstrip the component aspects. Painting, dyeing, appliqués, carving, piercing, abrading, sandblasting and more are all areas to explore. If you aren't particularly artistic, find someone who is. Collaborate with a family member, friend, club mate, local art school student or whoever can bring their skills to the final result. Once you head down the artistic path, you'll expand your turning horizons tremendously.

Airbrushed goose egg standing ornaments: a collaboration with the late Giles Gilson

A standing chicken egg ornament inside a standing goose egg ornament

A pierced and painted goose egg lidded box: acrylic paint and blackwood base and pull

Steambent and painted maple stand with pierced and painted goose egg ornament on African porcupine quill

Conclusions

My goal this month was to whet your appetite. I believe that most turnings can often benefit by the addition of other materials, colours and other enhancements. Shells are almost always very modestly priced and available. Your use of them can range from as simple as colouring them with some acrylic spray paint or nearly any artist's paint, to as complex as piercing, dyeing and painting. At either end of those extremes, you can get clever and make your shell part of your end result, whether a major or minor piece. There certainly are opportunities to include shells into more than lidded boxes and ornaments. Is using shells as part of your turnings for you? Perhaps not but being so simple and inexpensive, you don't have much to lose. I hope I've given you the basics and enough curiosity to give shells a try. ●

WT_290_75_80_KURT_HERTZOG_bdJRmbKHsd.indd 80 28/01/2016 15:00